

Turkish Suspended Affixation is Structure Sharing

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1 Background

Suspended affixation (SA) is a phenomenon where an affix only appears on the edgemost coordinands in the coordination, but takes scope over all coordinands (Lewis 1967, Kabak 2007, Erschler 2012, a.o.). SA can target both prefixes and suffixes, and there is no restriction on the number of coordinands. This paper only looks at coordinations with two coordinands. Also, since Turkish does not have any prefixes, this paper will focus on suffixes only too.

A number of suffixes from the verbal and the nominal domain in Turkish can undergo SA (see Kabak 2007 for a detailed summary) and this paper will concentrate on the nominal domain. The plural, possessive and accusative markers can all undergo SA (1). For example, although the plural suffix in (1a) only attaches to the second conjunct *köpek* ‘dog’, the entire phrase can have the meaning of ‘cats and dogs’ where the plural suffix takes scope over both conjuncts. Similarly, the phrase in (1b) can mean ‘my book and my notebook’ even if the possessive suffix is observed only on the second conjunct¹. The accusative suffix, although without a specific meaning, can also appear only on the second conjunct when both conjuncts in a coordination need to be case-marked (1c).

(1) SA behaviours in the Turkish nominal domain

a. Plural

kedi ve köpek-lar
cat and dog-PL
‘cat(s) and dogs’

b. Possessive

kitap ve defter-im
book and notebook-1SG.POSS
‘(my) book and my notebook’

c. Accusative case:

kedi ve köpeğ-i sev-iyor-um
cat and dog-ACC like-PROG-1SG
‘I like the cat and the dog.’

¹ The phrases in (1a) and (1b) can also mean ‘a cat and dogs’ and ‘a book and my notebook’ respectively if the context permits. Such variation does not affect them to qualify as SA or influence the analysis in this paper.

SA is a phenomenon observed in multiple languages and has been analysed with different methods. This paper aims to choose the more appropriate analyses for Turkish SA between the two major camps: structure sharing vs. ellipsis. I will show with the SA patterns of Turkish nominals that structure sharing is the better analysis for Turkish, although ellipsis has been argued to be more suitable.

The rest of the paper is arranged as follows: The remainder of section 1 sets out the nominal structure of Turkish (section 1.1) and introduces the SA patterns of Turkish nominals (section 1.2). Section 2 introduces the two competing analyses this paper aims to compare. Section 3 presents evidence against the ellipsis analysis. Section 4 provides a proposal based on the structure sharing analysis and explains how it accounts for the SA properties in Turkish. Section 5 concludes.

1.1 Nominal structure of Turkish

Since the paper focuses on the nominal domain of Turkish, it is worth figuring out the structure of nominals before getting into the analyses. The general order of morphemes in the nominal domain is ROOT-Number-Possessor agreement-Case (2). Genitive suffixes are added onto the possessors (2b), which are generally omissible when they are pronouns in Turkish (2c-d). Since the SA of plural suffixes is slightly complicated (see section for details), this paper will mainly look at the possessive and the accusative suffixes.

(2) Examples of how nominal suffixes are arranged

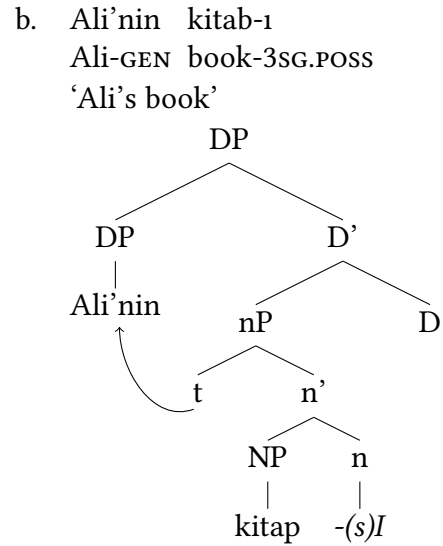
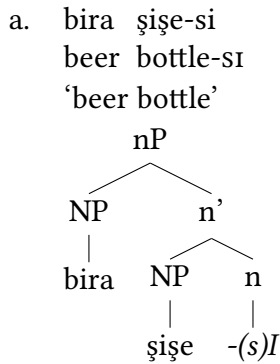
- | | |
|---|--|
| <p>a. Kedi-ler-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-PL-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like my cats.’</p> <p>b. Ali’nin kedi-si-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like Ali’s cat.’</p> <p>c. (ben-im) kedi-m
 (1SG-GEN) cat-1SG.POSS
 ‘my cat’</p> | <p>d. (o-nun) kedi-si
 (3SG-GEN) cat-3SG.POSS
 ‘his/her cat’</p> |
|---|--|

Turkish suffixes have been argued to head their own projections (Kornfilt 1997, 2005, 2012, Öztürk 2005). The NP projection hosting the noun and the DP projection encoding referentiality/specificity are relatively uncontroversial, but whether there is any projection between NP and DP is subject to debate. For example, some authors proposed ‘PossP’ to host the genitive possessor in its specifier and the possessive suffix on its head (e.g., Lewis 1967, Dede 1978, Kornfilt 1997, Göksel 2009). Kornfilt (2005) also made similar proposals that the agreement morphemes (i.e., the possessive suffixes in this paper) on the head of possessive phrases head the ‘AgrP’. Öztürk (2005) also adopted ‘NumP’ (Ritter 1991, Li 1999, Borer 2004, a.o.) for the interpretation of Number in Turkish nominals.

In this paper, I argue that there is an additional projection called ‘nP’, following the proposal made by Öztürk and Taylan (2016) for compounds formed by two nouns (NN compounds) and possessive constructions in Turkish. Öztürk and Taylan (2016) proposed that, in NN compounds like (3a), the obligatory compound marker *-(s)I* introduces an argument external to the noun as its argument. This functional projection headed by the compound marker is called ‘nP’, analogous to

vP (or VoiceP in Kratzer 1996) in the verbal domain which introduces an external argument to the VP. This argument introduced by the n head also needs to check its case. When the argument has a referentiality/specificity feature to check as in (3b) – for example, when the argument introduced is a possessor DP – it overtly moves into Spec,DP and triggers agreement via phi-feature checking with the D head. If the noun is non-referential, then it remains in Spec,nP. (Öztürk and Taylan 2016:102-103). The compound marker *-(s)I* and the possessive marker *-(s)I* are simply the Spell-out of the n head².

(3) Structure of NN compounds and genitive-marked possessive constructions proposed by Öztürk and Taylan (2016)

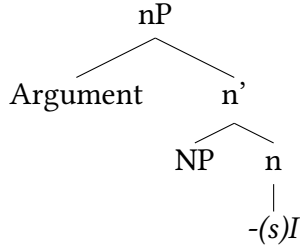


Since Öztürk and Taylan's (2016) analysis can correctly generate the patterns in (2), I will adopt their proposal, with only one modification. In Öztürk and Taylan's (2016:102) proposal, a DP possessor must check its referentiality/specificity feature 'through the D head via Agree', but the authors did not explain why this must be achieved by overtly moving the possessor to Spec,DP. I propose that the argument introduced by the n head in all nPs, regardless of whether it has referentiality/specificity features to check, stays in Spec,nP (4a). The feature-checking process could still be done through the D head via Agree, but with Spec,nP instead of Spec,DP. Although both NPs and DPs can appear in Spec,nP, only DPs receive the genitive case after checking its

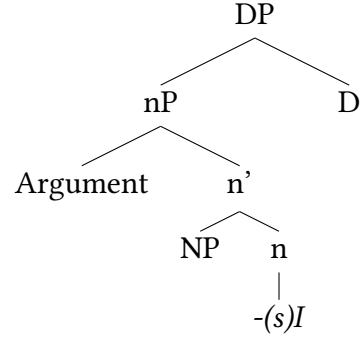
² There is abundant literature discussing whether these two suffixes are the same: Lewis (1967), Underhill (1976), Dede (1978), van Schaaijk (1996), Kornfilt (1997), Yüксеk (1998), and Göksel and Kerslake (2005) argued for the a single possessive suffix, but Swift (1963), van Schaaijk (1992), Göksel (2009), Kharytonava (2011), and Kunduracı (2013) argued that the *-(s)I* on NN compounds is a separate derivational compound marker. Öztürk and Taylan's (2016) argument essentially treats these two phonologically identical forms as the same without considering them both as the compound-forming suffix or as the third person possessive suffix by giving them a new function. Since this is not the main argument of the paper, I will not elaborate on why they are the same and just follow Öztürk and Taylan's (2016) proposal. I will also keep glossing the this suffix poss for the sake of consistency.

referentiality/specificity feature³. Another functional layer DP⁴ hosting the accusative case still exists above nP but no possessor obligatorily moves to Spec,DP (4b).

(4) a. Structure of nPs in this paper

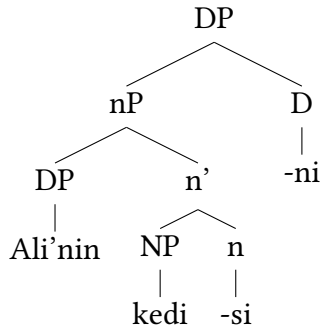


b. Structure of DPs in this paper



In this way, most of the nominals in the discussion that follows should have one of the structures in (5). Nominals with overt possessors like (2b) have the structure in (5a) and those without overt possessors have the structure in (5b), where the possessor in Spec,nP is silent because it is a pronoun.

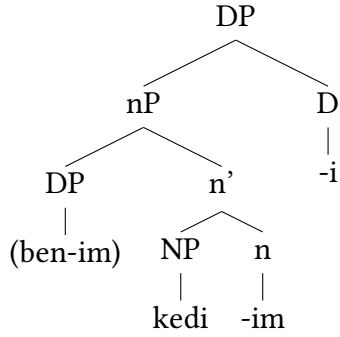
- (5) a. Ali'nin kedi-si-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 'I like Ali's cat.'



- b. Kedi-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 'I like my cat.'

³ Since how the genitive case is assigned and whether it must be assigned by overtly moving the possessor to Spec,DP is not the main topic of this paper, I will not go into details about the case-assigning mechanism. It is also possible to assign the genitive case to a DP inside an nP using a Dependent Case Theory approach (Marantz 1991, Baker 2015).

⁴ Öztürk and Taylan (2016) were also aware of the discussion on another functional projection independent of DP hosting the case (e.g., Bošković and Şener 2014) but chose not to consider this option. I will also not consider this option because incorporating this projection will not help with the problems of the ellipsis analysis later mentioned in section 3.



In summary, this paper follows Öztürk and Taylan’s (2016) proposal and assumes that there are three projections on the nominal spine in Turkish – NP, nP and DP. n introduces an external argument to a nominal and this argument can be either an NP or a possessor DP. But in contrast with Öztürk and Taylan (2016), this paper assumes that the possessor stays in Spec,nP.

1.2 SA patterns of Turkish nominals

Two characteristics of the suspension of nominal suffixes are essential to the arguments of this paper. First, multiple suffixes can be suspended together as long as no suffix is ‘skipped’ (6). If a suffix further from the root is not suspended, then any suffix closer to the root than this unsuspended suffix must also be retained on the non-final conjunct. For example, when the two conjuncts both have the possessive marker and the accusative marker when no suffix is suspended (6a), it is possible to suspend only the outermost accusative case marker (6b) or both suffixes together (6c). However, in (6d), because the outer accusative suffix is not suspended from the first conjunct, suspending only the inner possessive marker leads to ungrammaticality. The same applies to nouns affixed with the plural and the accusative markers at the same time (7)⁵.

(6) No skipping of suffixes is allowed, demonstrated with POSS and ACC

a. No SA at all

Kedi-m-i ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
cat-1SG.POSS-ACC and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
‘I like my cat and my dog.’

b. Suspending ACC

Kedi-m ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
cat-1SG.POSS and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
‘I like my cat and my dog.’

⁵ This generalisation persists when the plural and the possessive markers are both affixed to a noun, with only one additional restriction. The plural marker cannot be separated from the possessive marker, as shown below:

- (i) *Kedi-ler ve köpek-ler-im-i sev-iyor-um
cat-PL and dog-PL-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
Intended: ‘I like my cats and my dogs.’

As shown in the following sections, this generalisation is not absolutely necessary for choosing between the two analyses. To avoid further complication of the patterns, I will only mention the plural marker when it facilitates discussion.

- c. Suspending all suffixes
 Kedi ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like my cat and my dog.’
 - d. Suspending POSS without the outer ACC
 *Kedi-si ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-ACC and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: ‘I like (my) cat and my dog.’
- (7) No skipping of suffixes is allowed, demonstrated with PL and ACC
- a. No SA at all
 Kedi-ler-i ve köpek-ler-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-PL-ACC and dog-PL-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like the cats and the dogs.’
 - b. Suspending ACC
 Kedi-ler ve köpek-ler-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-PL and dog-PL-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like the cats and the dogs.’
 - c. Suspending all suffixes
 Kedi ve köpek-ler-i sev-iyor-um
 cat and dog-PL-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like the cats and the dogs.’
 - d. Suspending PL without the outer ACC
 *Kedi-si ve köpek-ler-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-ACC and dog-PL-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: ‘I like the cats and the dogs.’

Second, when the noun phrases in a coordination have overt possessors, suspension of the possessive marker is permitted only when there is one overt possessor at the beginning of the coordination taking scope over both conjuncts (8). For example, there is only one possessor *Ali'nin* ‘Ali’s’ at the beginning of the coordination in (8a), and this possessor takes scope over both conjuncts to deliver the meaning of ‘Ali’s [cat and dog]’ according to consultants’ judgement. So, it is possible to suspend suffixes as in (8b). However, when each conjunct has its own overt possessor (8c), suspension of the possessive suffix is not allowed (8d).

- (8) Possessive suffixes can only be suspended when there is only one possessor at the beginning of the coordination
- a. Ali'nin kedi-si-ni ve köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat-3SG.POSS-ACC and dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like Ali’s cat and dog.’

- b. Ali'nin kedi ve köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat and dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 'I like Ali's cat and dog.'
- c. Ali'nin kedi-si-ni ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat-3SG.POSS-ACC and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 'I like Ali's cat and Ali's dog.'
- d. *Ali'nin kedi ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: 'I like Ali's cat and Ali's dog.'

2 Competing analyses

SA has been found in many languages including Turkish (Kabak 2007, Broadwell 2008, Kornfilt 2012, Atmaca 2020, 2021, Türk 2024), Korean (Yoon and Lee 2005, Yoon 2017), Mari (Guseva and Weisser 2018), Ossetic (Erschler 2012, 2018), and Eastern Armenian (Erschler 2012). Analyses proposed for these languages are mainly divided into two camps, which I call 'structure sharing' and 'ellipsis' respectively. The table in (9) summarises the languages with SA and the analysis adopted by each author.

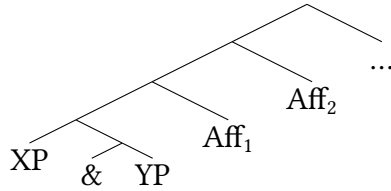
(9) Languages with SA and the analysis adopted by each author

Language	Literature	Analysis
Turkish	Kornfilt (2012)	Structure sharing (RNR)
	Broadwell (2008)	Structure sharing
	Atmaca (2020, 2021)	Ellipsis
	Türk (2024)	
Korean	Yoon and Lee (2005)	Structure sharing
	Yoon (2017)	
Ossetic	Erschler (2012, 2018)	Ellipsis
Eastern Armenian	Erschler (2012)	Ellipsis
Mari	Guseva and Weisser (2018)	Ellipsis

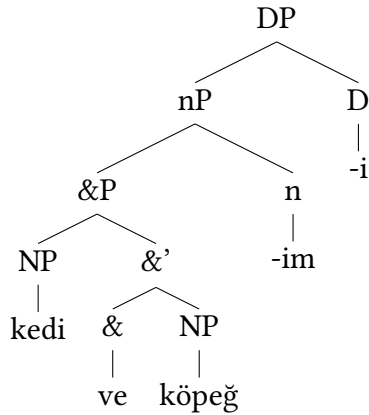
The first analysis proposes that the suspended suffix attaches to the entire coordination (10a). Whether the coordinate structure is binary does not influence the arguments here, so I will use a binary structure in what follows. This analysis has been used for Turkish by Kornfilt (2012) who argued that SA is similar to right node raising (RNR; Ross 1967, Postal 1974, Hartmann 2000, Chaves 2014, a.o.), and Broadwell (2008) who based his analysis on LFG. Yoon and Lee (2005) analysed Korean in similar ways, with the only difference being that the suffix takes DPs as complements in their system. Although differences exist in the exact implementations of these analyses, they all share two spirits. First, the suffixes are not generated within each conjunct. Second, the suspended suffix lies in a structurally independent position from the coordinated phrases so that it can be shared e.g., as the head of projection which takes the entire coordination as its complement. Therefore, I will call this approach the 'structure sharing' analysis. (10b) shows a Turkish

example analysed with structure sharing, where the possessive and the accusative suffixes attach to the coordinated phrases *kedi ve köpek* ‘cat and dog’ in order.

(10) a.

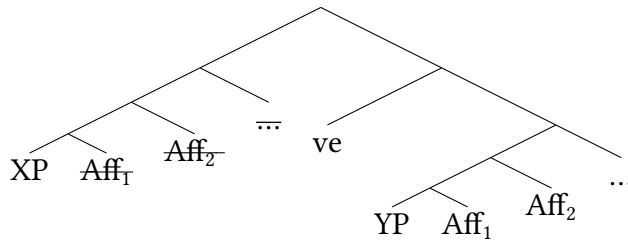


- b. Kedi ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like my cat and my dog.’

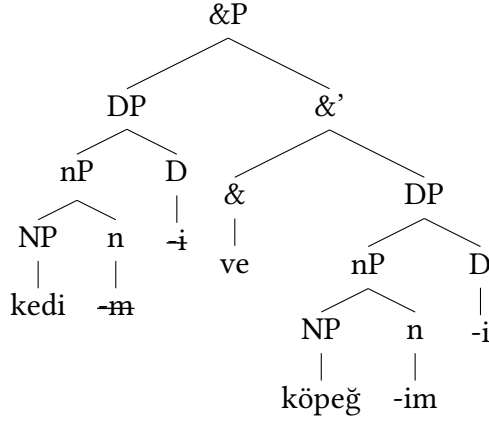


The second type of analysis assumes that the suspended suffix is generated within each conjunct, but gets deleted from the non-final conjunct when the materials are sent to the PF (11a). This post-syntactic deletion approach was first put forward by Erschler (2012, 2018) for Ossetic and Eastern Armenian and later adopted by Guseva and Weisser (2018) for Mari, as well as Atmaca (2020, 2021) and Türk (2024) for Turkish. I call this approach the ‘ellipsis’ analysis. (11b) shows how ellipsis works with Turkish again: The possessive and accusative suffixes are generated with the two NPs respectively, and those attached to the first NP gets deleted to get SA.

(11) a.



- b. Kedi ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like my cat and my dog.’



However, previous literature has not agreed on whether structure sharing or ellipsis is the better analysis. Although it is possible that different languages with SA use different mechanisms, an agreement has not even been reached for Turkish either. In the next two sections, I will show that ellipsis is unable to account for many SA behaviours of Turkish nominal suffixes and make a proposal based on the structure sharing account which avoid all the ellipsis-related problems.

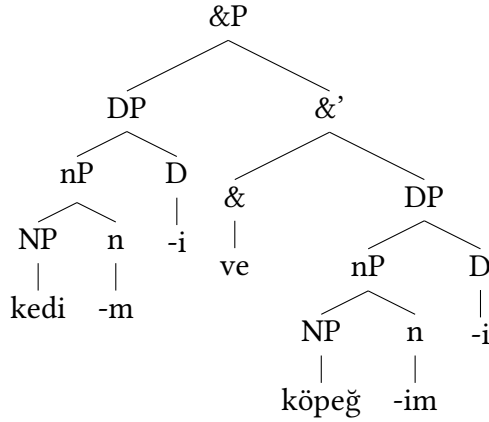
3 Limitations of Ellipsis

This section aims to argue against the ellipsis analysis from two angles. Section 3.1 to 3.3 provides evidence that argue against the general elliptical account based on the structure in (11). Section 3.4 engages with the more specific proposal by Atmaca (2020, 2021) and shows how it also fails to account for the SA patterns in section 1.2.

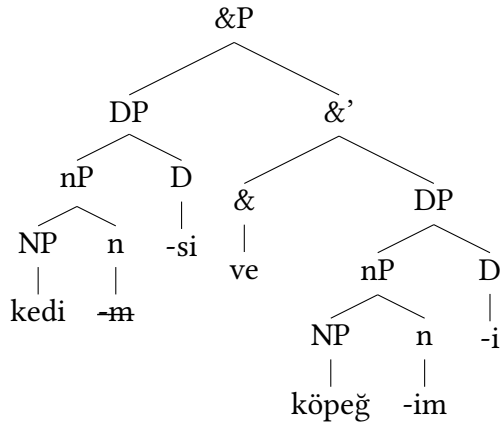
3.1 No skipping of suffixes is allowed

First, since the ellipsis analysis assumes that each conjunct has its own copy of the suffix and the suffixes on the non-final conjunct simply get deleted, a suffix at any position in a conjunct should be able to be removed. In other words, an inner suffix should still be able to be suspended even if the outer suffixes are not suspended. For example, in a coordination where each conjunct has both the possessive marker and the accusative marker (12a), the ellipsis analysis predicts that removing the possessive suffix from the first conjunct without eliding the accusative marker is possible. However, such ‘skipping’ of suffixes is not allowed (12b).

- (12) a. Kedi-m-i ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-1SG.POSS-ACC and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like my cat and my dog.’



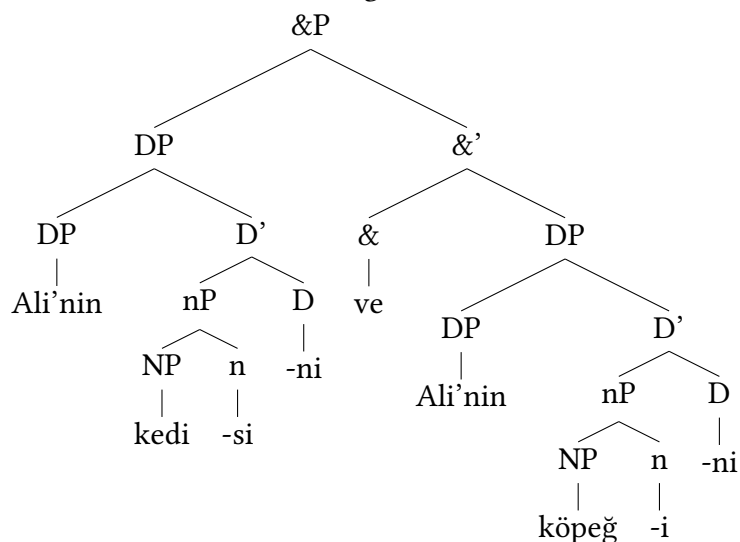
- b. *Kedi-si ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-ACC and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: ‘I like my cat and my dog.’



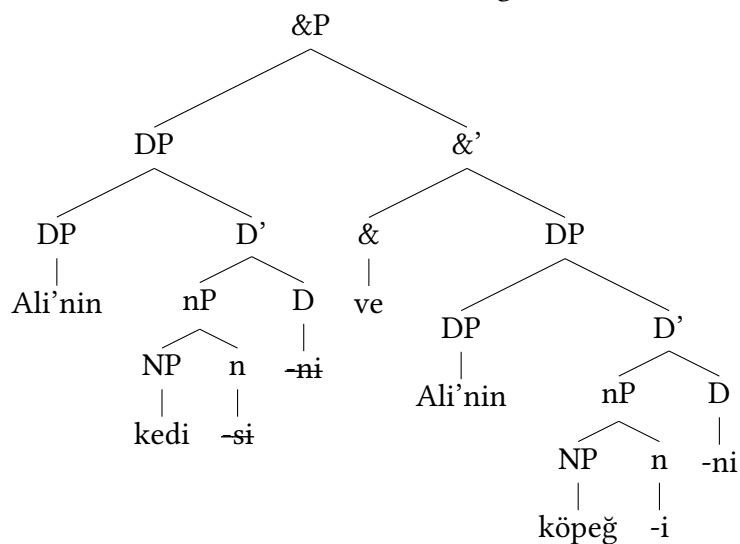
3.2 Possessive suffixes are not freely elided

Second, the distribution of the possessive marker when an overt possessor is present also argues against the ellipsis analysis. As illustrated by example (8) in section, when there is no SA, two coordinated nominal phrases each with an overt possessor should have the structure in (13a), where the possessor *Ali'nin* ‘Ali’s’ c-commands the object *kedi-si-ni* ‘cat’ (why such a structure is employed will be discussed in more detail in section 1.1). Under the elliptical account, suspension of all suffixes including the possessive marker should be possible as in (13b). However, this is not allowed and (13b) is ungrammatical.

- (13) a. Ali'nin kedi-si-ni ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat-3SG.POSS-ACC and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 'I like Ali's cat and Ali's dog.'

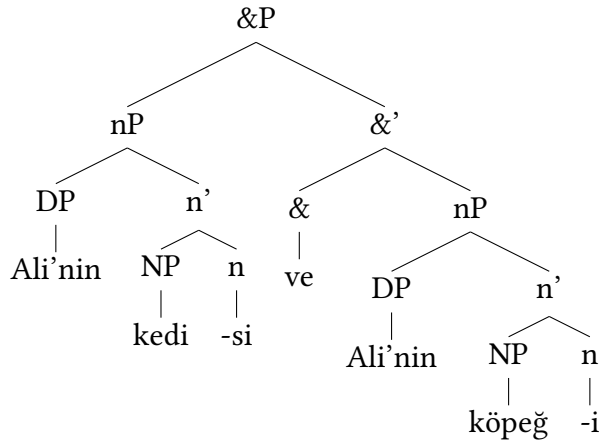


- b. *Ali'nin kedi ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: 'I like Ali's cat and Ali's dog.'

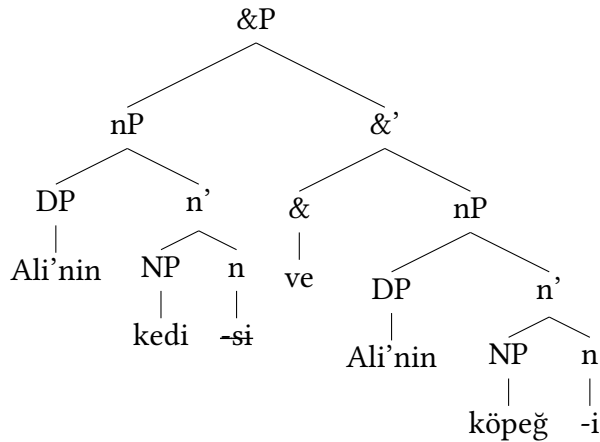


This problem persists even without the accusative suffix: Two conjuncts each with an overt possessor cannot share a single possessive marker either (14). But this is predicted to be grammatical by the ellipsis analysis.

- (14) a. Ali'nin kedi-si ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i
 Ali-GEN cat-3SG.POSS and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS
 'Ali's cat and Ali's dog'



- b. *Ali'nin kedi ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i
 Ali-GEN cat and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS
 Intended: 'Ali's cat and Ali's dog'



In short, the ellipsis analysis predicts that the possessive marker should be able to undergo SA no matter where the overt possessors lie, but the data suggest otherwise.

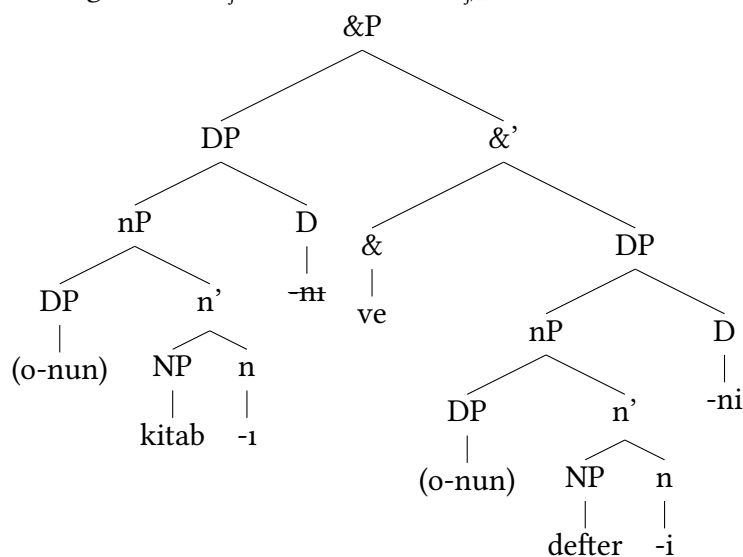
3.3 Absence of the non-coreferent reading

Finally, although it is possible to suspend the possessive marker when there is no overt possessor on either conjunct, the suspended possessive suffix cannot refer to two different individuals. Imagine a context where two merchants are at a fair, one selling a book and the other selling a notebook (15). The sentence without the suspension of the possessive marker (15a) can mean 'I bought his/her book and his/her notebook', which the consultants judged to be true in this context. Since the book and the notebook are sold by different merchants, (15a) shows that the unsuspended possessive suffixes can refer to different individuals. However, when the possessive suffix is suspended as in (15b), the consultants judged the sentence to be false in this context and only true when the book and the notebook are sold by the same merchant. In other words, the

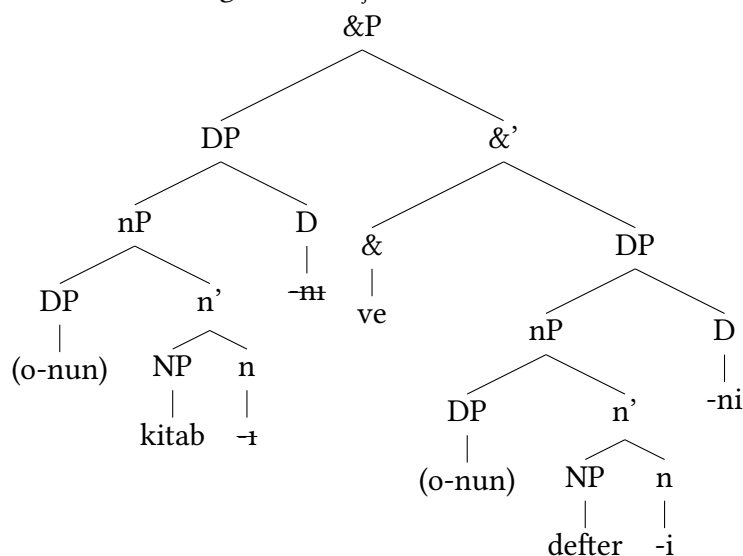
suspended possessive suffix can only refer to a single individual.

- (15) Context: There are two merchants at the fair selling stationary items. One of them sells a book and the other sells a notebook.

- a. Kitab-ı ve defter-i-ni al-dı-m
 book-3SG.POSS and notebook-3SG.POSS-ACC buy-PST-1SG
 ‘I bought his/her_j book and his/her_{j/k} notebook.’



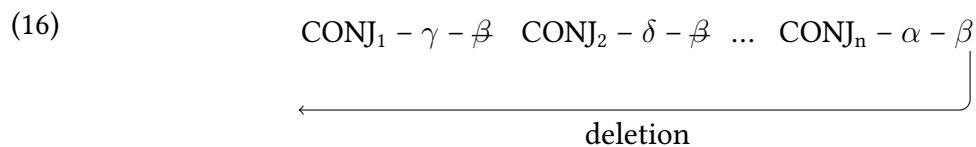
- b. #Kitab ve defter-i-ni al-dı-m
 book and notebook-3SG.POSS-ACC buy-PST-1SG
 Intended: ‘I bought his/her_j book and his/her_{#k} notebook.’



Under the ellipsis analysis, the two sentences should have the same structure as indicated by the two trees above, with the only difference being the ellipsis of the possessive marker on the first conjunct, and the grammaticality contrast between (15a) and (15b) should not exist.

3.4 Previous accounts

An elliptical account was explicitly developed for Turkish by Atmaca (2020), in line with Guseva and Weisser (2018) and Erschler (2018). Atmaca’s (2020:104) proposal considers SA as a ‘deletion of phonological exponents’. SA deletes the rightmost terminal node on each conjunct and this process proceeds leftwards. More specifically, in a conjunction with n conjuncts, SA begins from the right edge of every conjunct and removes the rightmost morpheme that is identical on all conjuncts. Then, this process is repeated for the rightmost suffix that currently remains on each conjunct, as shown in (16). Note that, since SA is an optional process, it is not required that the rightmost suffix must be deleted if it is identical in all conjuncts.



(adapted from Atmaca 2020:104, Figure 34)

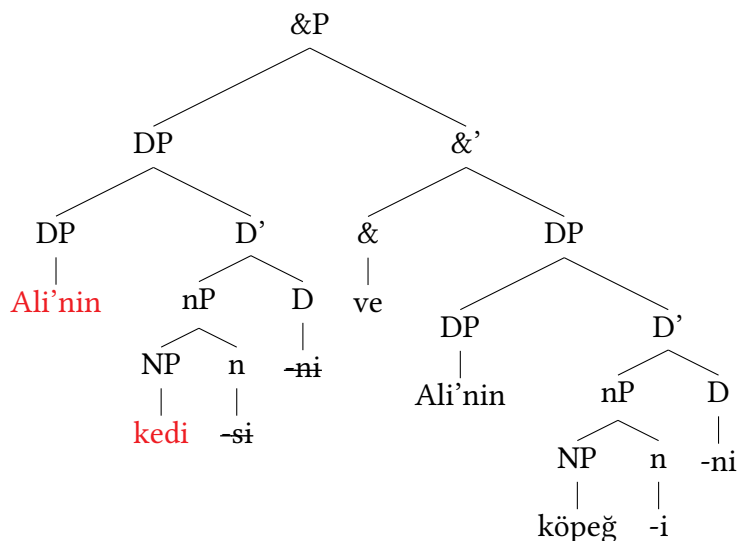
This account has two other components that makes it slightly different from the ellipsis analysis that I just argued against. First, Atmaca’s (2020:105) used ‘terminal nodes as target of deletion and not the actual morphemes themselves’. This point is non-trivial in explaining the inseparability of the plural and possessive markers, because Atmaca (2020:100) placed them on the same terminal node, namely the n head. Given that the aforementioned examples did not include the plural suffix, this additional point does not help explain the three problems in section 3.1 to 3.3.

Second, Atmaca (2020:105) emphasised the ‘morphological word status of what is left after SA’, and no further deletion of terminal nodes is allowed ‘if they are the last ones that constitute a morphological word’. Resulting in a non-word has not been a problem so far, because what remains after SA in these examples is usually an NP, which must be an independent noun on its own unlike some verb roots. ROOT-POSS and ROOT-ACC sequences also do not lead to non-words. So, this addition of the proposal also does help with the three problems above.

However, restricting what can be left after SA is indeed to possible way to explain the ungrammaticality of certain examples. Assume that what remains after SA must form a constituent. In this way, the ungrammaticality of (13b) is explained, because what is left in the first conjunct *Ali’nin kedi* is not a constituent (17).

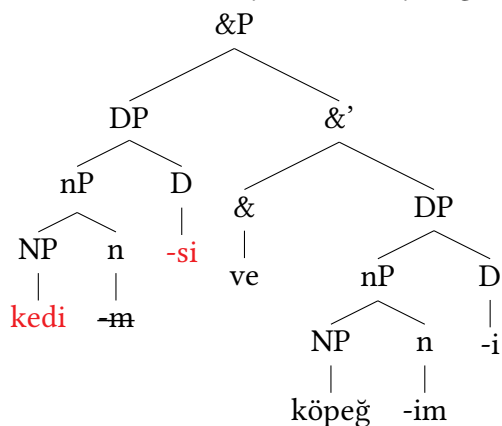
- (17) *Ali’nin kedi ve Ali’nin köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: ‘I like Ali’s cat and Ali’s dog.’

(13b, repeated)



Similarly, the ‘no skipping’ constraint is also derived because eliding a non-rightmost suffix results in a non-constituent in the first conjunct. For example, in (18), the NP *kedi* and the accusative suffix *-si* on the D head does not form a constituent. Alternatively, the ungrammaticality of (18) can also be explained by the fact that ellipsis must proceed leftwards in Atmaca’s (2020) proposal. Ellipsis should begin with the accusative suffix and proceed leftwards to the possessive marker, so it is impossible to leave the rightmost suffix on the first conjunct unsuspended whereas an inner suffix is elided.

- (18) *Kedi-si ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-ACC and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: ‘I like my cat and my dog.’



But only permitting constituents to be left unsuspended still does not help account for the absence of the non-coreferent reading. Even if the possessive suffix in the first conjunct is unpronounced, the covert possessors of the two NPs are still introduced by two different *n* heads in the underlying structure, so the sentence in (15b) should be able to describe the scenario where the two objects are owned by different individuals. But contrary to the prediction, (15b) does not have the non-coreferent reading. In other words, Atmaca’s (2020) proposal also fails to explain certain patterns of Turkish SA.

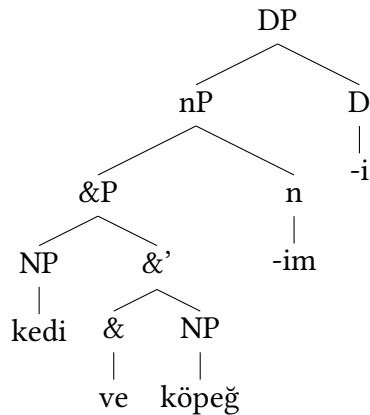
4 How structure sharing accounts for SA

The previous section has shown how the ellipsis analysis fails to account for many behaviours of Turkish SA. In this section, I will illustrate how the structure sharing analysis can circumvent these problems, and briefly discuss how this proposal responds to previous challenges to the structure sharing-based analyses.

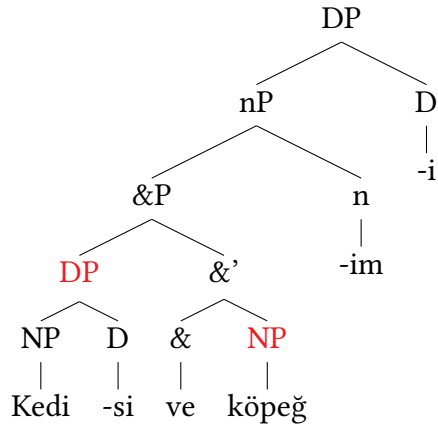
4.1 Skipping of suffixes is prohibited

Under the structure sharing approach, the restriction that an inner suffix must only be suspended when an outer suffix is also suspended can be easily derived. To preserve the relative hierarchy between the nominal projections on a fixed nominal spine (Cinque 2005, Zamparelli 2000, a.o.), if a suffix on a relatively lower head is already shared, the higher head must also be shared. As shown in (19), the structure sharing analysis predicts that, when multiple suffixes are suspended, the coordination should have the structure in (19a) where both the n head and the D head are shared by the two conjuncts. However, when one attempts to elide the possessive from the first conjunct without the accusative suffix being suspended too, coordination of unlike syntactic categories appears again, so (19b) is ungrammatical. Thus, the structure sharing analysis predicts that there should be no ‘skipping’ of suffixes.

- (19) a. Kedi ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like my cat and my dog.’



- b. *Kedi-si ve köpeğ-im-i sev-iyor-um
 cat-ACC and dog-1SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: ‘I like my cat and my dog.’



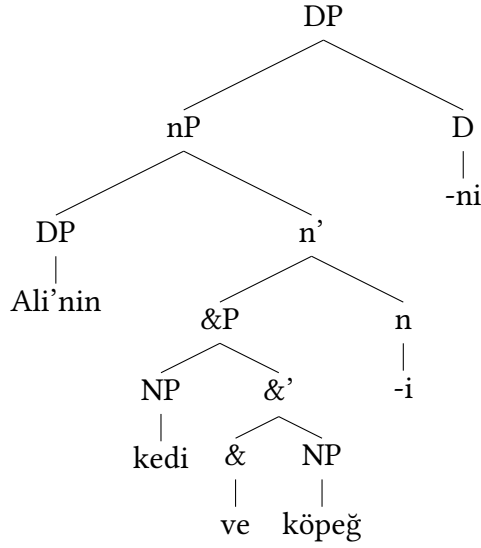
4.2 Restrictions on the suspension of possessive suffixes are derived

As shown by the data in (8), suspension of the possessive is only possible when there is only one possessor taking scope over both conjuncts at the beginning of the coordination. Section 3.2 demonstrated that the ellipsis analysis has difficulty explaining this generalisation, but this pattern naturally falls out of the structure sharing account.

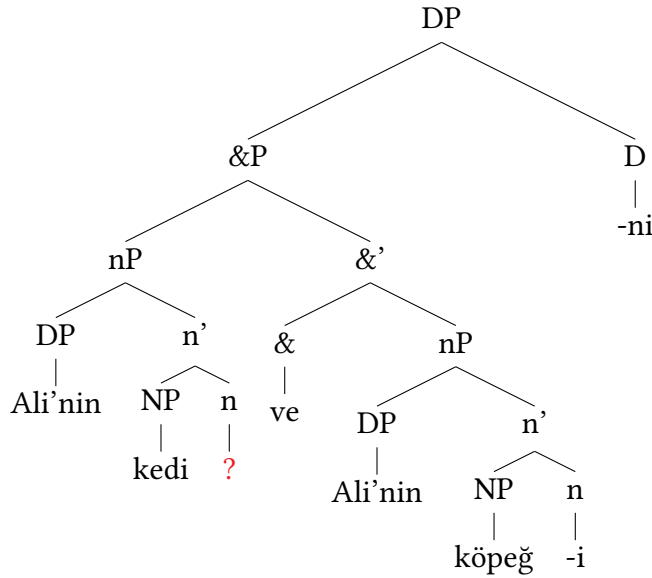
It can be concluded from definition and structure of nP in section 1.1 that the n heads and the arguments need to be in one-to-one correspondence. Every n head can introduce one and only one external argument to a noun. Therefore, for every overt possessor in the external argument position of a nominal, there must be one instance of the n head. Also, because the third person possessive marker *-(s)i* is the Spell-out of the n head, every n head that must exist will correspond to one possessive suffix.

As a result, when there is only one possessor at the beginning of the coordination, suspension of the possessive marker is possible because there is only one overt possessor as the external argument of the entire coordinate structure. The ‘suspended’ possessive suffix is the Spell-out of a single n head that introduces the external argument possessor to this coordination (20a). This can be easily explained by the structure sharing account in the sense that the n head is shared by the two coordinated NPs. However, when each conjunct has its own overt possessor, they must each have an instance of the n head. That is to say, the Spell-out of the n head on the first conjunct is not omittable (20b). Therefore, it is unable to suspend the possessive suffix when there are two overt possessors.

- (20) a. Ali’nin kedi ve köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat and dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 ‘I like Ali’s cat and dog.’



- b. *Ali'nin kedi ve Ali'nin köpeğ-i-ni sev-iyor-um
 Ali-GEN cat and Ali-GEN dog-3SG.POSS-ACC like-PROG-1SG
 Intended: 'I like Ali's cat and Ali's dog.'

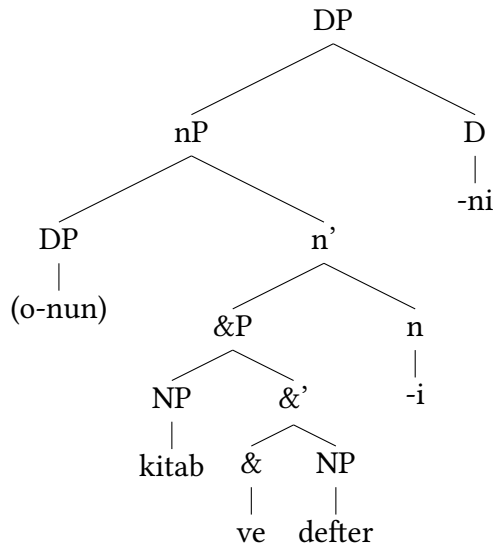


4.3 Obligatory coreferent reading under SA derived

Finally, the obligatory coreferent reading when there is no overt possessor under the suspension of the possessive suffix can also be accounted for by the structure sharing analysis with the aforementioned logic. Although the possessor is not overt, there is still a silent *o-nun* 'his/her' in the external argument position in each conjunct or the entire coordination. Under the structure sharing account, when the possessive suffix is suspended, it is actually shared by the two coordinated NPs. The *n* head that this suspended possessive marker corresponds to introduces a possessor to the coordination *kitab ve defter* 'book and notebook' (21). Hence, both the book and the notebook must be owned by the same individual. To get the non-coreferent reading, each conjunct must have its own covert possessor and – more importantly – the *n* head that introduces

each possessor. Hence, the non-coreferent reading cannot be obtained when there is only one instance of the n head.

- (21) #Kitab ve defter-i-ni al-dı-m
 book and notebook-3SG.POSS-ACC buy-PST-1SG
 Intended: ‘I bought his/her_j book and his/her_{#k} notebook.’



To briefly conclude, this section so far has shown that the structure sharing account successfully explains the SA generalisations in Turkish that the ellipsis analysis struggles with. Three characteristics of the structure sharing analysis leads to the proposal’s success, including (i) the idea that a suspended affix is shared by the coordination; (ii) the relative hierarchy between NP, nP and DP; and (iii) the one-to-one correspondence between the n head and the possessor in the external argument position.

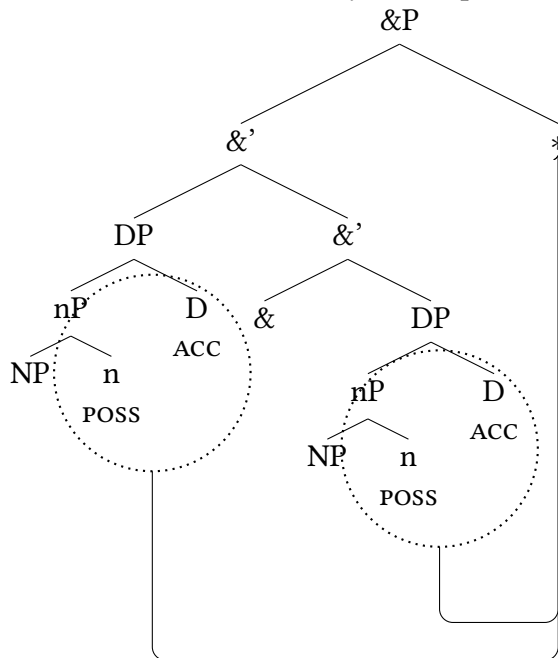
4.4 Response to arguments against ellipsis

Although the structure sharing analysis in this paper is shown to be more suitable for Turkish SA, there were arguments against the structure sharing account. This section re-evaluates such arguments with regards to whether they pose potential challenges to the current proposal.

The authors who did not adopt the structure sharing analysis for Turkish are Atmaca (2020, 2021) and Türk (2024). The arguments explicitly against structure sharing and for ellipsis mainly came from Atmaca (2020). Türk (2024) simply accepted the reasoning given by Erschler (2012, 2018). However, Atmaca’s (2020) arguments were quite weak. First, Atmaca (2020) only considered the RNR analysis under the structure sharing camp, and argued that the RNR analysis is only possible with an additional assumption that the target position that the possessive and the case suffixes move into can form a complex head (22). More specifically, Atmaca (2020) proposed that suffixes need to move to a ‘pseudo-specifier position’ (marked with * in ex. 22) which by default holds only one terminal head. Also, suffixes have to move in the order from the outermost to the innermost; that is, D moves to the ‘pseudo-specifier’ first, followed by the n head. So, to avoid the wrong surface order *ROOT-Case-Possessor agreement, ‘an assumption of forming a complex head needs to take place’ (Atmaca 2020:103). Given that the elliptical account does not require

additional assumptions, the ellipsis analysis is better.

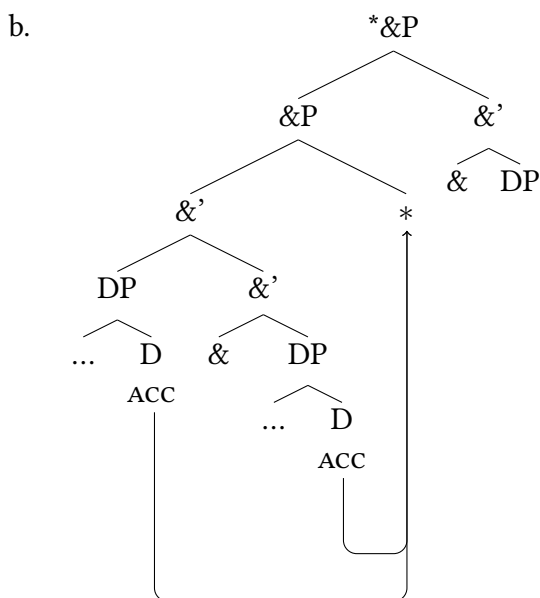
(22) Atmaca's (2020) RNR analysis (adapted from Atmaca 2020:103, Figure 32)



I argue that this is not a good argument against the structure sharing camp, because the approach without movement discussed in this paper – which is able to avoid such assumptions and deliver the correct surface morpheme order – was completely ignored. The current proposal successfully avoids this morpheme order problem by making the nominal heads directly take the coordination as their complement. As shown in section 4.1, because the relative hierarchy of nominal projections is constant, the morpheme order does not change even when they are suspended. As the D head is always higher than and to the right of the n head, the accusative marker will always appear to the right of the possessive marker. Hence, there is no need to assume a ‘pseudo-specifier’ position that can hold complex heads.

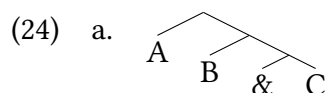
Second, Atmaca (2020) argued that the RNR analysis incorrectly predicts that, in a coordination with three conjuncts, it is grammatical to suspend a suffix only from the first conjunct (23a), because RNR does not demand movement to take place from every non-final conjunct to the right edge of the coordination. In other words, it is possible to suspend the accusative suffixes to the pseudo-specifier position first, and conjoin the entire &P with another DP *defter-i* ‘notebook (ACC)’ as in (23b). This argument has two flaws. On one hand, the example provided in (23a) is not a case of SA, because SA refers to structures where the suffixes appear *only* on the rightmost conjunct. On the other hand, the ellipsis analysis does not necessarily predict the ungrammaticality either, because it does not demand deletions to take place in every non-final conjunct by default. That is, to make sure only the final conjunct carries the suspended affix, an additional assumption must also be added to the ellipsis analysis. Atmaca's (2020) elliptical account, albeit delivering the correct prediction, in (16) is in fact the general ellipsis analysis plus this additional assumption. So, Atmaca's (2020) argument that the ellipsis analysis is better because it does not require additional assumptions does not hold, since both analyses require additional assumptions to work.

- (23) a. *kitab, kalem-i ve defter-i getir
 book pencil-ACC and notebook-ACC bring.IMP
 Intended: 'Bring the book, the pencil, and the notebook.'

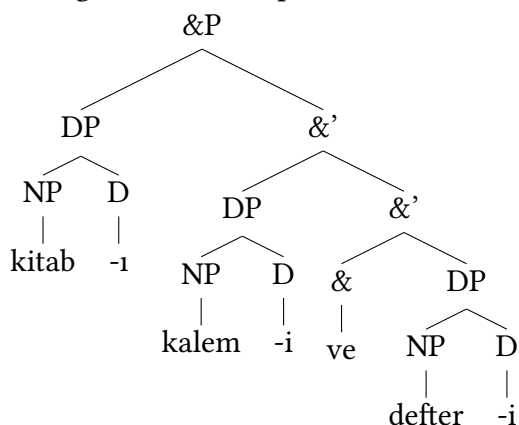


(adapted from Atmaca 2020:104, Figure 33)

Also, Atmaca (2020) analysed the coordination with three conjuncts differently from the traditional analysis. Coordinations with more than two conjuncts but only one coordinator are sometimes called 'Multiple Coordinate Complexes' (Zhang 2010). As shown by Winter (2017), Multiple Coordinate Complexes are not derived from repeating coordinations with two conjuncts, so they should have the structure in (24a) instead of that in (23b). The tree in (24b) shows the correct structure for Multiple Coordinate Complexes without SA.

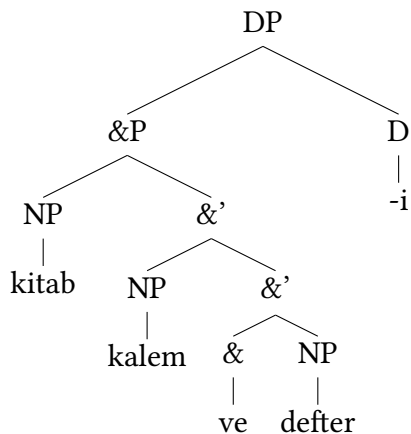


- b. kitab-ı, kalem-i ve defter-i getir
 book-ACC pencil-ACC and notebook-ACC bring.IMP
 'Bring the book, the pencil, and the notebook.'



Consequently, the structure sharing proposal makes the correct prediction of the grammaticality of (23a), but the ellipsical account does not. That is, to make sure SA does not change the structural relation between the three conjuncts, one must suspend the accusative suffix by making the D head take the entire coordination as its complement (25). Trying to suspend the accusative marker of only the first two conjuncts will lead to the incorrect structure of the three conjuncts in (23b). In contrast, the ellipsis analysis, without the assumption that matching materials from *all* non-final conjuncts must be elided, cannot predict the ungrammaticality of (23a).

- (25) kitab, kalem ve defter-i getir
 book pencil and notebook-ACC bring.IMP
 ‘Bring the book, the pencil, and the notebook.’



In short, the arguments against the structure sharing account by Atmaca (2020) had their own flaws, because the author only considered the RNR option of structure sharing and used the incorrect structure for coordinations with three conjuncts. An implicit assumption that Atmaca (2020) included in the ellipsical account was also ignored. With the correct option of structure sharing and the structure of coordinations, the proposal in this paper successfully avoids the challenges by Atmaca (2020).

4.5 Crosslinguistic application

A final question that merits some discussion is whether the current proposal works for languages like Ossetic that strongly favour the ellipsis analysis? Out of the two reasons provided by Erschler (2012, 2018) for the ellipsis analysis, one of them indeed makes the structure sharing account invalid. Erschler (2012) showed that case markers in Ossetic do not head their own projections with the binding properties of depictives (26) and reflexives (27). Both case-marked NPs in (26a) can co-index with the third person pronoun. However, when the name *χeteg-i* is embedded in a PP (26b), it can no longer co-index with the third person pronoun. This contrast shows that both NPs in (26a) c-command the third person pronoun, but *χeteg-i* in (26b) does not because of the intervening PP projection.

- (26) a. Case-marked NPs *can* bind pronouns
 Soslan **χeteg-əj** rasug-ə tərs-uj
 Soslan.NOM **χeteg-ABL** drunk-ABL be.afraid-PRS.3SG
 ‘Soslan_i is afraid of Xetaj_j when he_{i/j} is drunk.’
- b. NPs in PPs *cannot* bind pronouns
 Soslan **χeteg-i** **χeccə** rasug-ə dzor-uj
 Soslan.NOM **χeteg-OBL with** drunk-ABL talk-PRS.3SG
 ‘Soslan_i is talking to Xetaj_j when he_{i/*j} is drunk.’

(adapted from Erschler 2012:169)

Simiarly, *Soslan-i* in (27a) binds the third person reflexive but *Soslan-i* in (27b) does not. So, the NP *Soslan-i* in (27a) c-commands the third person reflexive and does not head another projection like (27b). These two examples both show that case markers on NPs do not head their own projections.

- (27) a. Case-marked NPs *can* bind reflexives
 e=χe-mə_{i/*j} **Soslan-i_i** ba-vdiston
 POSS.3SG=self **Soslan-OBL** PRV-show.PST.1SG
 ‘I have shown Soslan to himself.’
- b. NPs in PPs *cannot* bind reflexives
 *e=χe **Soslan-i** **χeccə** ba-zongə kotton
 POSS.3SG=self **Soslan-OBL with** PRV-known do.PST.1SG
 Intended: ‘I have shown Soslan to himself.’

(adapted from Erschler 2012:169)

However, the key for the structure sharing account to function is that there are some structures to share. If the case-marked NPs in Ossetic do not head their own projections like Turkish, there is no point using the structure sharing analysis either.

If the generalisations showing that case markers in Ossetic lack a structural position hold, the structure sharing analysis is indeed inapplicable, because there is no structure to share. However, whether a language uses the structure sharing or ellipsis analysis could arguably be a parameter in UG controlled by the structural position of the suspended suffix. If the suffixes in a language do not head their own projections, the ellipsis analysis is adopted. In contrast, languages whose suffixes do head their own projections will utilise the structure sharing approach. I leave this as an open question for future research. Nevertheless, this paper has shown that structure sharing must be part of the linguistic theory in order to generate the correct crosslinguistic pattern.

5 Conclusion

In this paper, I have shown with evidence from the SA behaviour of nominal suffixes in Turkish that structure sharing is a more appropriate analysis than ellipsis for Turkish SA. My arguments are mainly based on three facts: (i) Turkish does not allow the ‘skipping’ of suffixes in SA; (ii) the possessive suffix can only be suspended when the two conjuncts do not each have their own overt possessor; and (iii) a suspended possessive suffix forces the coreferent reading of the possessor in each conjunct. I also offer a structure sharing analysis, which is able to avoid the three problems

that the ellipsis analysis fails to solve. Finally, the structure sharing analysis in this paper does not necessarily conflict with the evidence from other languages that prefer the ellipsis account. Although it remains an open question whether structure sharing is the *only* correct analysis for SA crosslinguistically, it must be included in the syntactic theory to cover the full range of SA behaviours in the world's languages.

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